

# EMWA



ETHIOPIAN MEDIA WOMEN ASSOCIATION Vol 2 No. 1 August 2008



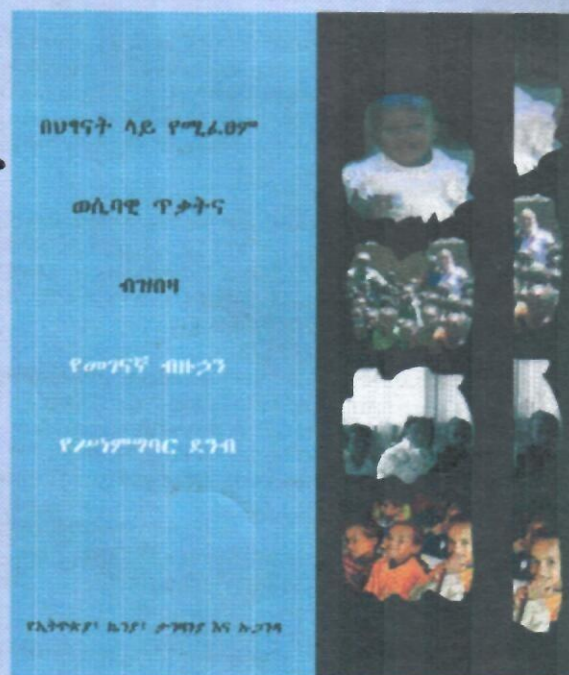
## EMWA launched a Media Code of Conduct

EMWA has released a Regional Media Code of Conduct that provides guidelines on how to report on cases of Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation (CSAE) on the 24<sup>th</sup> of June 2008.

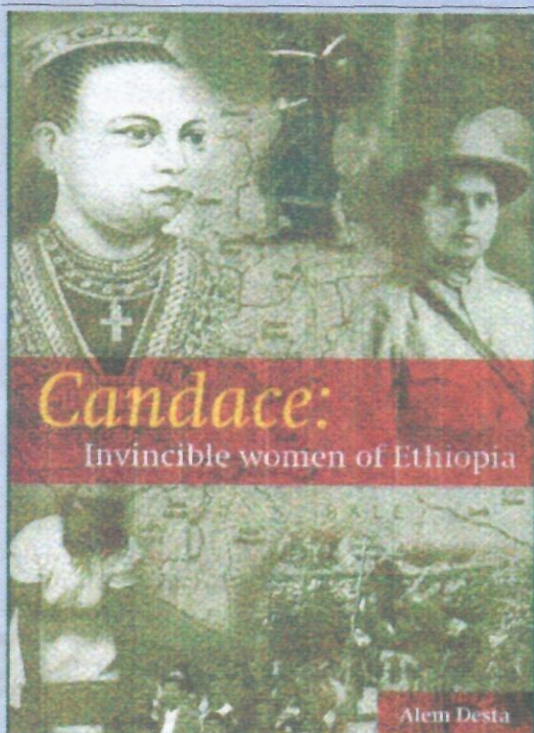
The launching ceremony was held at Axum Hotel, Addis Ababa with the presence of Ato Fantahun Asress, a representative of Ministry of Information, journalists and representatives from media houses, government and NGOs working with and for children.

The code of conduct is produced as part of a joint advocacy campaign project of the network

*contd. to page 2*



EMWA Newsletter



## EMWA co-produced a book on women & leadership

EMWA co-produced a book on women and leadership with Stichting Ethiopie Millennium (SEM), a Netherlands based organization. The book entitled: "Candace: Invincible Women of Ethiopia" is written by Alem Desta, an Ethiopian by birth living in the Netherlands, with the contribution by EMWA.

196 pages book, "Candace," was initiated with the view of recording the history and contributions of Ethiopian women from 1900 on wards. The

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## Media Code of Conduct...

*contd. from page 1*

of East Africa Media Women's Associations on Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation (CSAE).

The CSAE code, among other things, strictly prohibits the media from exposing child survivors of sexual abuse because this affects them psychologically and may cause them to suffer from anxiety, depression, and further stigmatization thus affecting their future lives.

The media code is co-produced by the Associations of Media Women in Kenya (AMWIK), Uganda Media Women's Association (UMWA), Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) and Tanzania Media Women's Association (TAMWA).

Journalists, academicians, lawyers, children, government and non-government organizations working with and for children participated in developing the code. EMWA collected inputs on the draft code from children and journalists by organizing discussion forums early February this year.

The code is made available in four languages common in East Africa, namely, Kiswahili, Luganda, Amharic and English.

The launching ceremony was accompanied by an award ceremony of children's essay contest on CSAE. In the competition children from SOS village Bahir Dar ranked 1<sup>st</sup> and 3<sup>rd</sup> while a girl child from Lazarist school in Addis Ababa ranked 2<sup>nd</sup>.

Correspondingly, EMWA organized a two-day Training of Trainers for journalists on reporting on CSAE, from June 23- 24, 2008 at Axum Hotel. Some 40 from Addis Ababa and regions took part in this training that aimed at familiarizing participants with the guidelines and equip them with skills on how to report on CSAE. EMWA had conducted training for journalists and a workshop for editors on reporting on CSAE in September last year.

## EMWA aires a radio program on CSAE

EMWA is airing radio programs regarding Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation (CSAE) for the second time on FM 96.3 starting from the 7th of July 2008. The radio program is produced under the OAK Foundation supported project of the East African media women's associations on CSAE.

EMWA had aired eight consecutive radio programs from November 29th last year focusing on the causes of CSAE, consequences of CSAE on abused children, on negative actors and on measures need to be taken to curb the problem. Children, parents and school communities in three schools and kebele 13/14 of Yeka Subcity participated in the radio programme, among others, through a radio-listening group established in the schools and the Kebele administration.

In the current program, which is being aired every Monday from 4:30 pm for 20-minutes and repeated every Friday at 3:00pm, EMWA facilitates discussions on issues of CSAE and media.

## EMWA co-produced a book...

*contd. from page 1*

book provides an account of achievements and challenges of Ethiopian women working in various fields through portraits of 22 remarkable female individuals who have made and are making significant contributions to their communities and Ethiopian society at large.

The book, which is also translated in Amharic language as “ህጻናት፡-ጽኑዎች የኢትዮጵያ ሰብዓት” was launched at a ceremony organized in collaboration with National Organization for Women (NOW) on 15<sup>th</sup> July 2008 at Panorama Hotel, Addis Ababa. Ambassador Sahlework made key note speech at the event where higher government officials, celebrities, and women groups were in attendance. Representatives of the producers of the book, Executive Directress of EMWA Wz. Abebech Wolde and Dorothe Appels of /SEM/ and the author, Wz. Alem Desta also made speeches. A critique on the book was also presented by Wz. Zenebework Tadesse.

The launching ceremony was accompanied by a half day training organized for young women leaders from Addis Ababa University and other higher learning institutions.



# NEWS

## EMWA organized a forum on Freedom of Speech

On 6<sup>th</sup> June 2008, EMWA organized a forum for its members on freedom of the press and access to information. During the forum, Ms. Alice Klement, a U.S Fulbright Scholar who is teaching graduate journalism students at the University of Addis Ababa, and three FK North/South to South exchange participants EMWA hosts shared their experiences and the practices of freedom of the press in their respective countries. EMWA had also held a forum under the theme: "Let's honor our success" in connection with International Women's Day, on March 7, 2008 at its office. Veteran radio journalist Wz. Tsheay Tefredegne shared her rich experiences. EMWA had an honor of W/ro Hirut Befecadu, the first Ethiopian to become an Information officer for the then OAU and who have served as a member of the UN Peace Keeping mission to speak on the role of media and media women in ending impunity for violence against women and girls last year.

EMWA forum is organized for members to discuss on different issues affecting members, their profession and women. It is planned to be held every two months at the association's office.

## Change of Office Location

EMWA has moved from its office around 22 Matoria to Piazza, around Ras Mekonnen Delidye, Tena Kebede Building 2<sup>nd</sup> floor, H. no. 601. It has also changed its logo.

The previous logo of EMWA was...



The new logo of EMWA is ...



## EMWA forwarded comments on the new draft Press law

EMWA forwarded its concerns and comments on the new draft press law, which is now promulgated, to the legislation body by reviewing the draft from a gender perspective. EMWA observes that some of its comments are taken up by the legislation body and incorporated in the law. A case in point is an explanation is included in the preamble on the generic use of the pronoun "he" to refer female and/or male.

Likewise, EMWA facilitated for the content as well as the consultation process on the draft become gender-sensitive by organizing series of meetings for members, journalists, communications officers and women groups in Addis Ababa and regions, who were marginalized in the process. The association held a consultation meeting for its members on 5<sup>th</sup> January by the support of Pact Ethiopia. A Local and a South African experts presented papers. EMWA also organized discussion forum for communications officers, journalists and women groups from the capital and regions in Addis Ababa and Bahir Dar by the support of Friedrich Ebert Stiftung (FES).





# NEWS

## Networks Of Journalists On Reproductive Health To Be Established

EMWA and Consortium of Reproductive Health Associations (CORHA), are working together to establish network of journalists in four regions; in an attempt to achieve better reporting and coverage of the issues of reproductive health and the supplementary challenges that women face. With this regard both associations have so

far given a number of workshops in different regions of Ethiopia. Basically, they have traveled to Amhara, Tigray, SNNP and Harari regions and organized workshops in each region for editors and journalists who are based in these places. They also organized two training programmes.

## EMWA PARTNERS WITH EAST AFRICAN WOMEN ASSOCIATIONS

In collaboration with three East African media women associations EMWA is currently conducting a Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation (CSAE) project. The project is funded by the Oak Foundation and includes the Uganda Media Women Association (UMWA), Tanzania Media Women Association (TAMWA) and the Association of Media Women in Kenya (AMWIK).

To date EMWA has conducted three separate trainings for journalists and editors till present. These trainings have created awareness among media practitioners on their coverage of children and their issues. During the October training the Forum for Street Children presented some of their findings from a one-year media monitoring report which they are soon to release. EMWA also presented a report on a three month child coverage print media monitoring carried out between October and December 2006.



See also news code of conduct on page 1

## A documentary film exhibiting EMWA's development produced

The 30 minutes documentary showcases the growth of EMWA from its inception in 1998 till present. It shows the challenges EMWA passed through and the contributions it has made

towards advocating the causes of women and children at large. The documentary is believed to be a great resource to the history of the association and to any

individual or organization who wants to know more about the association's progressive stages and areas that it has worked. The film was watched by some EMWA members.

## EMWA HOSTED

## PARTNERS MEETING

The Ethiopian Media Women Association hosted the Fredskropset North-South Exchange Program partners' meeting 10th and 11th March 2008, at EMWA's office, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.

The objective of the meeting was to review the on going exchange program and discuss on the phase out strategy since this is the last phase of this particular exchange programme.

The North to South Exchange Program is an exchange of professionals among the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA), Ethiopia; Tanzanian Media Women's Association (TAMWA), Tanzania; Gimlekollen School of Journalism and Communications, Norway; and the Norwegian Broadcasting Corporation (NRK), Norway.

EMWA has exchanged eight participants with partners in Norway in four years time.

EMWA had also hosted South-South partners meeting in October 2007. The South-South exchange program is also an exchange of professionals among five media women associations in Africa. EMWA was primary agency for the media women associations network of FK-south-south participant exchange program in 2007.



## Happy endings and new beginnings:

*Preparatory and Home Coming Seminars successfully carried out for Fredskorpset exchange participants from 10 African countries.*

**F**or some, it was their last duty as Fredskorpset (FK) participants while for others it was the beginning of an interesting journey as they prepared to face the challenges and joys of living in a foreign country. This was the FK Homecoming and Preparatory Course for the South/South Participants in Addis Ababa.

FK Africa in collaboration with the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) brought together former FK participants and new FK participants. The FK 2008 Home Coming was held on January 9<sup>th</sup> and 10<sup>th</sup> 2008 at the Axum Hotel in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. The seminar brought together over 52 participants of the 2007 period FK Exchange programme participants and partners drawn out from organizations like ANPPCAN, MWAs, CHAM and Agri-business from 10 African countries.

The main aim of the homecoming seminar was to reflect on the experiences, achievements and challenges of the 2007 exchange programme phase so as to take corrective measures for the next period. To that end discussions and presentations were made on the progress from last year homecoming seminar, on challenges and on psychological needs (on how to confront the homecoming with experience from abroad in own luggage).

For two weeks, the Red Cross Training Centre was a melting pot for Africans of different nationalities brought together by the FK. Forty new participants underwent the preparatory course, bracing themselves

for a challenging year abroad. They came from 10 African countries; Ethiopia, Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Zambia, Malawi, Mauritius, Nigeria, Ghana and Liberia received insights into intercultural communication, development, health and positive thinking.



A year as an FK-participant can start in many ways, whether it is colorful religious parades or holy water that cures headache. Just ask the participants at the South/South FK preparatory course in Addis.

"I did it for fun. But it really worked! Before I went to the place called Janmeda, where Ethiopians were celebrating Epiphany, I was struggling with a terrible headache. After I was sprinkled with holy water, it went away. So this tells me something: my stay in Ethiopia for the coming 10 months will be pleasant." **Sarah Ngwenya from Zambia said.**

This is the fourth time that the FK preparatory course has been arranged in Addis, and the third time that the Ethiopian Media Women Association is hosting it.

The preparatory course is a first taste of what the participants might expect. They come to a new country, where the food is different from home. Language wise, Ethiopia has its own language with its own alphabets, Amharic, and it is used with pride. Some might feel a bit left out when they cannot understand what is being said around them.

"But this is what we have to adapt to when we took part in an exchange program and have a desire to spend 10 months abroad in this program. And the bright side of the story is that we get to see things that we have never seen before, like the Epiphany and other parts of Ethiopian culture." **Snadra Chidimma Anyanwu of Nigeria said.**

The preparatory course coincides with Ethiopian Epiphany, a colorful celebration to memorize Christ's baptizing at Jordan River. One day participants of the FK preparatory course were brought from their "home" in Addis-the Red Cross Training Centre to see the colorful parades at Janmeda.

"The parades were amazing, so colorful. You really have something to be proud of here in Ethiopia. The Ethiopian Culture is wonderfully unique. You are so independent, and keep your values. I can understand that this is the cradle of mankind!" **Prince Owusu Yaw Amoako from Ghana said.**

**P**articipants also gave their witness regarding the usefulness of the courses. They said it was an event that met its objective: preparing participants to the new journey to new environment. Sessions on appreciative inquiry, intercultural communication and development were very important and relevant according to comments of most of the participants.



# THE STRONG WOMEN

I see them everywhere. The single mother who makes a career, the widow who supports her family, women who attend full-time university program while working, female police officers, hardworking women in the countryside and women who fought during The Derg. Women I truly admire.

Before I came to Ethiopia I did not know much about gender and women issues, and I have never been an activist for women's rights in Norway. By all means, I was in support of equal rights, equal salary and so on but it all seemed at bit distant from the life I was living. I did not face many challenges concerning gender inequality in my daily life. I have to say EMWA has expanded my knowledge during this exchange period. Ten months does not make me an expert on women's issues but I have gained a lot of knowledge from what my Ethiopian friends tell me, what I see on the street and from what I read.

In Ethiopia, statistics indicates that 80 percent of Ethiopian women face violence in their marriage, which gives us an idea of how many destinies there are out there. Early marriages are rampant in the rural areas, and 9-year-old girls can get married. In addition to this, there is also a physical damage. Her husband might have been married before, or slept with other women, and he can infect her with HIV. Also, when a young girl gets pregnant, her body is not yet ready

to give birth.

Rape is another issue, and new statistics show that 75 percent of the per-



**Anette Os**

sons accused of rape is set free because of lack of evidence. Marital rape is not even seen upon as real crime. A female Ethiopian journalist told me about a meeting where she asked why marital rape was not seen upon as a crime. Several men who attended the meeting laughed back at her, and said that this was not a crime; it was rather a topic only between the husband and wife. Many of the Ethiopians I have talked to, say that inequality it is a cultural issue. I have no master degree in this area to analyze this, but I am sure it can partly be explained through intercultural communication, sociology and anthropology and last but not least psy-

chology. Why does the man continue hitting his wife? Was he hit when he was just a kid? Did he see his father hit his mother? And did his father see his grandfather hit the grandmother? Does this environment shape them? I don't know.

Good initiatives are underway in Ethiopia. The government has committed itself to overcome violence against women by passing and enforcing laws that ensure women's rights and punish abusers. However, there are challenges concerning practical application of the law.

At the same time, women are getting aware about their rights, from countryside to governmental institutions. Various women's rights activists are undertaking different advocacy activities, such as training media people, having lessons in schools and public rallies. However, the battle for gender equality is not yet won. Only when women gain their place as equal members of society will for instance violence against women no longer be an invisible norm but, instead, a shocking irregularity. I have met many strong women in this country and even though gender equality is not yet satisfactory, the women are certainly not victims. Ethiopian women are aiming for the sky. My stay has for sure given me lasting impressions.



# FIRST IMPRESSION IN ETHIOPIA

What you really know about Ethiopia, perhaps, it's not enough! When I arrived in Addis-Ababa, I was like wool! , guess what, first I was impressed by the weather at the airport Bole-Addis -Ababa. It was too cold compared to other airports in East Africa; not as they say it is 13 months of sunshine. Surprisingly weather is like that of Europe, and I have a saying Europe in Africa. One cannot just dare to move out without a jacket or a sweater anything that can keep you warm. And at night it is even worse off! Oh! My God! For those of you who are interested to move out at night and have fun, it's not the case. You just decide to stay indoors and watch television or sleep. The breeze is so cold with few sun intervals during day time that last for only 10 to 15 minutes and the weather changes drastically.

When it comes to having a bath, is not as easy as you think, you cannot dare having it with cold water as it is in Uganda, unless otherwise you try hot water.

And if you are used to easy communication using a mobile, and the internet, this is not the case in Ethiopia, to access the simcard it's a nightmare! It's not the way you think that any time you can access the simcard. You either rent it as they term it or forget about it.

As if this was not enough, if you need to change your money, it's also another hassle to access the foreign currency; you need to be with the air ticket to prove that you are moving out of the country. Surprisingly the

Ethiopian people are contented with the bureaucracy.

Despite of all what I was impressed of, I must confess that Ethiopia has



**Sanyu  
Namusaazi**

got the best tarmac roads, they are wide enough and seem to be long lasting. The period that I have been in Ethiopia, I have never seen a pothole but only to see the up coming Sky-scrappers. I guess, in five years to come Ethiopia will be the nice country to live in.

Ethiopia has got about 82 local languages, but the most popular ones are: Amharic, Tigiringna and Oromifa. That you can't mis hearing the tone, as they speak is like they are singing. And when it comes to the type of food, 'INJERA' which is the staple food made of 'teff' floor, being baked locally or using electricity for those who can afford.

I remember when I first tested it, wool!

It was like eating chapatti, that one in Uganda which is made from wheat flour and circled then sprinkle 2-3 spoons of cooking oil as you are preparing it. You can as well call it EKIKAMANDO"

The Injera food was so delicious, served with a lot of (lumb meat) or mutton commonly known as 'tibus' 'spiced with hot chili! Guess what! I got used to it, and I cannot just have a meal without chili, neither to miss a spiced meal with 'tibus' and INJERA in a week. You know what the scientists recommend to eat INJERA because it has got too much iron content. For those of you who are in doubt of your iron content in your bodies. Just try it out you won't regret it.

## Let us

Let's work together  
Walk on both legs  
Let's win our goal  
To finish the race  
To make change in our  
lives  
To developed with in what  
lies  
To show the world we  
are strong  
That we were strong  
All way long  
Let's make our day  
Sunny\* bright  
By our work  
We can make light  
We can shine through  
We can make changes  
To show the world what  
We are worth  
Let us hold hands

THAT WE WERE, WE ARE,  
WE WILL BE AND EVEN  
THEN STARS TO SEE...

Sofia Esmael  
Melat bahta  
Hilina Alemu  
Faculty of Journalism and  
communications AAU



# ASSUMPTIONS

**H**OLD your assumptions lightly! Is one good as section I gained from the Fredskopset (FK) 2008 Exchange programme while living in Ethiopia.

To be very honest during the interviews of FK programme at Zambia Media Women Association (ZAMWA) they asked me that "if I was to be an FK participant which country would I want to be posted and give reason why?" I told them that my first choice of the country of posting was Kenya because I was in Kenya, Nairobi before hence it was going to be easy for me to settle in Nairobi than Addis Ababa.

My reasons for not choosing Ethiopia was because the international media reports were not so encouraging for me to come to Ethiopia and stay for a long time therefore those were my first impressions about Ethiopia.

**BUT** render when I arrived and started staying here I was speechless, the country is amazing, it's eye-catching, full of beautiful looking people, natural and a gorgeous land scarping it is irresistible.

Addis Ababa is the city I am currently working in. It's super busy when it comes to traffic, people and just the country itself and it has abundance of natural wonders just to say the least the country is stunning.

I have been working with Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) as a Journalist for the past six months and I am very excited to work in this organisation. It's such an experience for me, very rich experience for me as an individual. I have learnt to live and work with people of different culture than Zambia.

I have never worked in a Non-Governmental Organisation (NGO) before, where you deal with projects, donors, partners, productions of publications, books, planning meetings. Seeing it's engagement with partners in planning international conferences is outstanding and to be precise as an exchange participant from Zambia, I have become part of an Ethiopian committee for organizing an International Conference to be held in 2009 on Child Rights.

The commitment that EMWA has when it comes to advocating for women and children's rights and in ensuring marginalized groups are given space to be heard as they are part and have the right to participate in any developmental issues of country is remarkable.

"Just come to think about it, one thing that I might pursue when I go back home is setting up an NGO that deals with women or joining an NGO that deals with children or women

issues"! This is because working with EMWA has taught me to have an experience or feel of what women or children go through".

**T**he programme, nonetheless, is still on and I am still enjoying every bit of it, I still have four more months to go. During this months, I will be attached with The Ethiopian Herald Newspaper and am very excited about this attachment because it will give me an insight of the media in Ethiopia, their work culture, their challenges and will provide me a platform for me to share my experiences from Zambia to my fellow Ethiopian media practitioners.

My private life had been very excellent at the same time got hit with a few challenges which with God I indeed overcame.

I have traveled to few places in Ethiopia for sight seeing such as Awassa, WendoGenet, Entoto, Langano and Sodere and gone dancing with friends, eat and drunk Ethiopian traditional foods and beverages.

Fitting in the community has not been difficult because many people have told me that I look like an Ethiopian women (*Habesha woman*) and I love it, you can not believe that when I go shopping people would be talking to me in Amharic so you can imagine the language challenge in responding and all I would say is *Eshe* meaning Okay.

Above all my exposure has been rich and I learnt a lot and will take back home rich knowledge as a result of living in Ethiopia, the people's day to day life. I would love my Zambian people especially the youth to emulate the youth of Ethiopia in their demonstration in respecting pregnant women, disadvantaged people and the aged people within the society. It is so amazing.

The way Ethiopian people love God, each time we drive passing by a church they would stop to make a way of the cross. (*this is not to say that Zambians don't love God but I don't just see that so much in my country*)

From my personal experience I have learnt how to not be judgmental but rather hold my assumptions lightly and that I must get to the bridge first and figure out how to cross it when I am there.

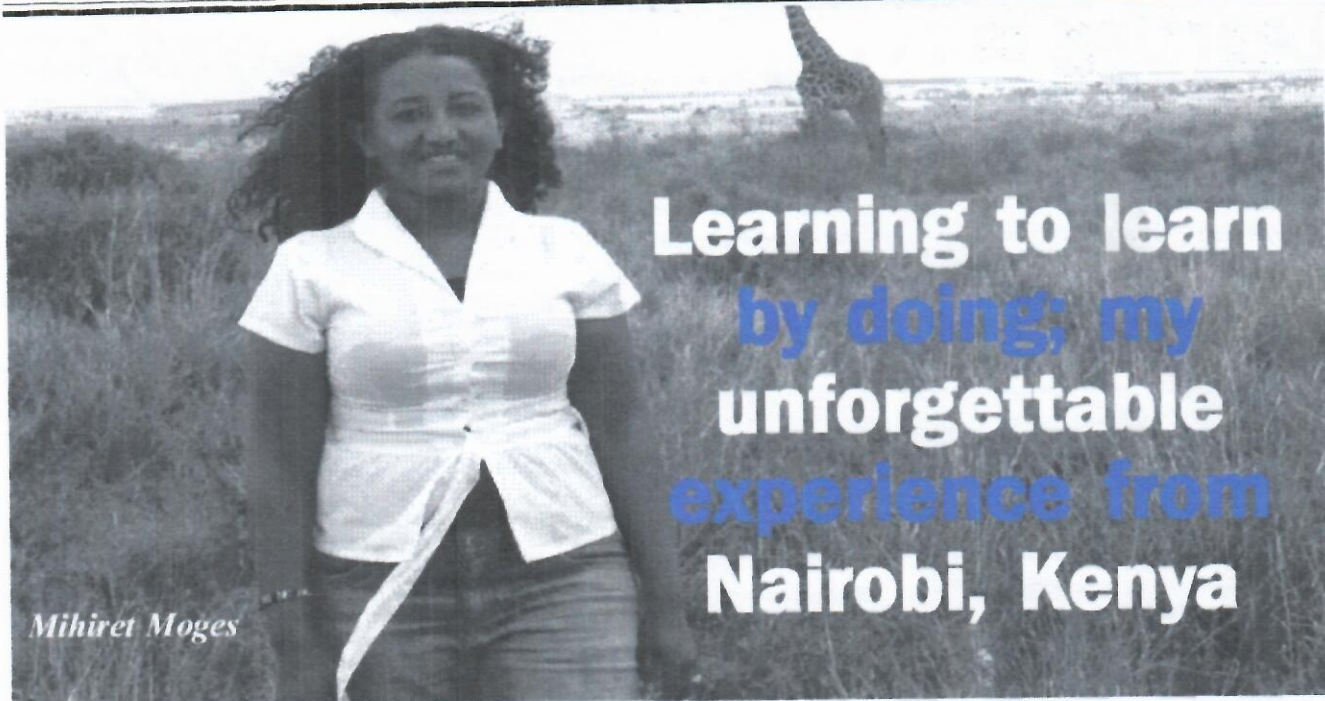
In Zambia I work with the international media called **Insight News-Zambia** as an Editor/Assistant Chief Bureau

**Hasabachun sebsbu Dildyunim  
tishageralachu. Igaziabher Ymesgen  
Ameseignalehu!**



**Sarah  
Rumbidzai  
Ngwenya**





Mihiret Moges

“When you are away from home you are a guest; when you are away from your country you are a stranger.” That was the one and only impression I had before life itself whispered to me the other way round.

As a person who had limited experience and exposure to other countries way of life, no wonder that I could be in the mood of confusion learning that the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) had elected me to be attached with a sister association in Kenya, the Association of Media Women in Kenya (AMWIK).

But, I had to confront that reality no matter how hard it could be. Be it as it may, for one's surprise, it took me a while to convince myself and live up to the expectation of my association. Accordingly, I made myself to be ready for immersing myself in to such new experience that could definitely offer me the greater opportunity to entertain several perspectives of people from different walks of life.

It was hard to live and work abroad since it was my first time out from my home land.

However I found being a stranger is the best way to learn different issues from different perspectives. My expectation was positive and I definitely expected my horizon to be more widened especially in relation to my profession of journalism.

To my surprise this new experience in Kenya and my interaction with different sections of the society was astonishing. My interface with almost everyone; particularly women, children and the youth has provided me with diverse knowledge and understanding. Though this experience has still some commonality by virtue of being African nations, my stay had still new horizons. It created an opportunity to experience some spectacular experience unique to Kenya only. As the Ethiopian saying goes; “One's ear is deaf to listen what happenings around.” So much so, I happen to understand that my knowledge regarding our neighbor Kenya was limited unlike the advantages of globalization and proximity.

Being introduced to vibrant and young and veteran Kenyan journalists equipped me with first hand information about the

political, social and economical status of the country and new lessons regarding several doctrines in general and my own profession in particular.

This ever first experience of mine has accordingly enabled me to realize that it is always better to completely submerge in to different cultures, languages and working atmosphere of people if someone wants to generate the best out of such interactions. I don't have to be social anthropologist or a communication expert to know that. That exposure itself gave me a chance to know this fact. It is certain that “practice makes a person perfect!”.

During my stay in Nairobi, I had an opportunity to participate in different workshops dealing with diverse social, economic and political issues. I learnt the role of both women and the youth and other vulnerable parts of the society have to be equally considered if democracy, good governance and equality have to be the order of ones country.

*contd. to page 10*



## Learning to . . .

*contd. from page 9*

**H**ence I had the possibility to look in to the position of men, women and children in the decision making process, their role in politics, their social and economic status and so on in the system that the incumbent Kenyan government is passing. Though our station was in Nairobi, at times, we had a chance to visit other pertinent places in the country. One of AMWIK's programs is providing training for women aspirants and journalists on the use of media. In relation to this, my first journey outside Nairobi was Kakamega, some 537 km away from the capital Nairobi. The training was organized for women contenders in Nyanza of the Western province. Being part of the organizers, I have learned how the Kenyan media and journalists dedicate themselves in portraying women candidates and women issues in general.

Kakamega was also the place where I first got the chance to see pigs physically. It was in a market place that I saw them and this phenomenon is new to most Ethiopians for they are not common in our country. First I shouted and felt with full of surprise. My housemate Ms Zawadi Machibya from Tanzania Media Women Association asked me why I shouted and I told her it was my first time to see a pig in flesh. That incident also made everyone including the merchants to laugh. Seeing a pig for them is just the same as seeing sheep for Ethiopians. Of course, I know that there are few farms in Ethiopia and also one can buy pork from the supermarket, but still it is not as such common to see them in market places and on the street like other domestic animals. Another thing common for most Christians and Muslims in Ethiopia is that they don't include pigs as food in their menus due to religious restrictions.

My second trip was to Garissa district some 380 km away from Nairobi, where Somali-Kenyans live. This was my first experience to meet and visit pastoralist communities. We went there to monitor the radio programs broadcasted to the area. As part of this task our bigger mission was monitoring the listening groups under the National Civic Education Program (NCEP); one of the programs being carried out by AMWIK.

**P**eople in Garissa were so nice and sociable. They are good at identifying strangers and interacting with them in a very profound mood. It didn't take them a while to smoothly communicate with strangers like me and I was so satisfied with the way they treated me during our short stay in the province. Some of them were even good at easily identifying me that I am from Ethiopia and attempted to speak with me in Amharic, Ethiopian official language. People of that locality are multilingual and fluently speak Somali, Arabic, Afaan Oromoo (one of Ethiopian language), Kiswahili and English among others. Most of them do not attend them. Children in that locality do not have access to education because cultural and other reasons. As in most African countries women in this locality are vulnerable to many social, economic and other problems apart from poverty prevailed in the society the traditions of this society trap women not to entertain their rights. They do not have the right to own property but on the contrary they are the one who shoulder majority of the activities in each household. Unlike most parts in my own culture women are even forced to carry out activities outside their home including farming. Resources are fully controlled by men. Some women groups in the country, in collaboration with AMWIK have been struggling to change the scenario for the better.

In Garissa, the only thing that I was embarrassed about is to be the only woman who wore a trouser, which is against their culture and religion. I could have asked people about their attitude towards this and adjust myself in a similar fashion. This was one of the best lessons I had from this village.

Mombasa, one of the most significant towns in Kenya, is a key spot for importing and exporting of goods and is a major destination for tourists from all around the world, was a place where I was most fascinated about. That island, with glorious stretches of white sandy beaches and coral reefs arrested my heart and mind. I was astonished with the beautiful gifts that nature offered to man kind.

Learning Kiswahili, predominant language, was the other challenge I had to face during my stay in the country. I had to learn the language through practicing it and avoiding fear what so ever when I make errors. In so doing, even if I failed to be fluent, I managed to understand the basics. In this, the support and assistance by Mr. Joseph Chacha Marwa, my Kiswahili teacher, was largely instrumental. He also supplemented me with other Kenyan cultural information. He taught me much about the diverse cultures (food, dressing, dowry, marriage and tribes...).

**A**ll in all, this exposure by itself has been an important venue to have diverse knowledge. I could say that my stay in Kenya, working with the AMWIK, was the time I have enjoyed every piece. That exposure remains to be a spectacular opportunity to interact other society outside my country. It was indeed an experience up on which I had a chance to see, know and contrast life, history, culture, people, geography and other heritages. I learnt to learn things rather than focusing on theory.



## My 10 month stay in Tanzania; the life time experience I would like to call

If there was one thing that made me sick and tired while I was in Tanzania for almost a year it was the non stop questions asked by almost everyone regarding my homeland Ethiopia. This compacted story that I would like to share with you is somehow fetched from my note in my diary book.

One thing at the heart of my diary and something that always strike me is the one I wrote regarding the Ethiopian Millennium we celebrated a year back. Most Tanzanians I encountered never stopped asking when I first disclosed that Ethiopia had been preparing itself to celebrate its second millennium. "Does that mean I will be 7 years younger than I am now if I come to Ethiopia?" "So, have you added seven years on your age here in Tanzania? Were some of the questions I was expected to respond to." In doing so, I had to explain regarding our calendar that is peculiar and on the way regarding the unique alphabetical letters, our history and all that. "Why do you frequently like to call other African people "Africans" and chose to call "African food, African dress African dance and so on" as if you are not African? was the other difficult questions I had to respond. The other question which I was asked repeatedly was "Are you still on war? Why you people like war...?" Thanks to my experience in journalism, I attempted to respond to these questions and others of this type systematically and with full commitment and dedication. Tanzanians never get tired of asking about Ethiopia. And my presence there seemed to answer their questions, dilemmas and confusions as far as information regarding Ethiopia is concerned.

"There are lots of untold stories about Ethiopia besides poverty, hunger and war that your ears have been acquainted and that I think is because of the western media" was the phrases I used to use as way of introduction in responding to most of the questions of such type. Surprisingly, let alone days but ten months was even not enough to explain the entire situation in my country and persuade those people. Explain existing situation regarding Ethiopia was a difficult task as many Tanzanians have the wrong impression regarding my country Ethiopia.

Tanzanians could be categorized in two groups in terms of their know-how regarding Ethiopia. Their knowledge is viewed in terms of their age groups; the youth and Elders/Adults. Most young Tanzanians seem to fail in having the full picture of the current Ethiopian as compared to those who are in their fifties, sixties or so. To my surprise some even fail to know or take them minutes and hours to notice



*Hlibite Tesfaye*

whether Ethiopia is to the north, south, east or west of Africa.

"My country Ethiopia is the only African country which has never been colonized and owns its own Alphabets and calendar! The gallant fathers and forefathers of this nation have sacrificed their flesh and blood for this proud and astonishing history of this unique country...!" This were the frequent explanations I used to utter in all the venues I encountered, be it in informal or in the informal ones. To my surprise this was of no interest to this young Tanzanians unlike the elder. Since they are young they need the fresh history of the country.

They were rather very much interested as to how the country started modern education and opened universities with out being colonized as if this is one criterion to have the modern system of education. Most Tanzanians of this group, which I talked to, can not think of entertaining the fruits of the new technologies with out being colonized. They wonder as to how we could begin the system without being colonized. I always see them being surprised of knowing that Ethiopia was among the pioneers in Africa in terms of what the developed countries are advocating now as the western civilization

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EMWA

## My 10 month stay in Tanzania...

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In this regard, as I frequently tell them, the contribution of the religion centers and their subsequent educational system in the building block towards the commencement of modern education in Ethiopia. Ethiopia, as to my latest information launched its first University ten years prior to Tanzania. And there was not even a university but rather a University College. This was back in 1961. I was good at deceiving all the Tanzanians I encountered and it was a good opportunity I can say to change the image of my country in the new millennium. I used to tell them that Ethiopia is among the first few East African countries to start telecommunication service. I didn't deny that poverty, hunger and the frequent wars that the country has witnessed has adversely contributed towards not sustaining the civilization that the country was popular about during the first millennium. I was so surprised to hear that adults from that country are very well aware of the history of Ethiopia. They say that Ethiopia is a mother of Africa and exemplary for independence and unity. "I was a junior reporter when Emperor Haile Selassie visited Tanzania," was what these group of journalists used to tell me.

Most ethnic groups in Tanzania believe that they are descendants from Ethiopia. They also refer the East African history as an evidence for this preposition. These people actually want to know about Ethiopia in detail. They mention names which they used to know and ask eagerly: "Are there such kind of names in your country?" "Please marry my son and let me get back to my original blood through my grandchild," which were asked by a father from "Chaga" clan was what surprised me most.

People, who have got the chance to visit Ethiopia / Addis Ababa for a meeting or landed for a transit, would like to mention two major things. The first one is the Addis Ababa's road lights. The Ethiopian Airline flight from Muwalimu Julius Nyerere International Airport arrives at Bole International Airport at night and for the people electric power is like heavenly water which every one can not entertain, the road lights in Addis are a miracle which they never forget. The new building of the airport has also taken their heart and mind for which they do not stop talking about.

The other main reason that keeps most Tanzanians of being reminded about Addis Ababa is the beauty of the women as they used to tell me. They recall that moment they spent in Addis and talk with out interruption and will be taken by the memory of the beautiful Addis Ababa's women. These were particularly men.

Let me now share how I observed Tanzania during my stay. The population of Tanzania accounts for about 38 million. There are about 120 nations and nationalities in the country. The country is gifted with natural resources. The country is partially surrounded by Indian Ocean that makes the country a home for wonderful beaches. The people are very interactive, respectful and entertain-

ing. It is very common greeting with strange people on the streets and buses, "Daladala" as the natives call them. Getting taxi services in Tanzania is somehow very different from the one I know in Addis Ababa. The one we call "Taxi" in Addis are synonymous with that of the "Bus" in Tanzania and they do not have city bus. The difference between Tanzanian buses "Daladala" and Addis Ababa city buses is that the buses in Tanzania are smaller. Taxis in Tanzania are what we call here "Lada".

In Tanzania there is no limit of passengers on this transportation method. As long as there is a place to step on, it is okay to be squeezed. The responsibility of the traffic police is to control the traffic not the number of passengers on a bus. It is really very hard to travel with the small bus especially for the tall people like me. Since it is not possible to stand, I have to bend myself at some part of my body.

Fighting to get a seat or safe place to stand is a must and the way of dressing must be appropriate to the transportation. If a seat is secured that is a great achievement but still you are expected to carry other people (those who can not get seat). You also have to carry bags, baskets and sometimes babies. The bus conductors do not allow spaces to be occupied by bags and baskets on the bus and the people who are seated have the responsibility to carry those stuff.

If you do not get a seat the only chance you have is to breathe properly before you reach your destination especially when there is a heavy traffic for there is a break in the middle of the journey. During this time the door of the bus will be open and those passengers who are standing will have time to relax on the streets. Whatever the transport situation is in the country you never see and hear people complaining about it. But I for sure witnessed that there is poorest transportation system in the country. The people seem comfortable on what they have which again surprises me and asked myself that change is hard for these people as they keep on silent. "It is also the same if you go to Kenya," people replied carelessly whenever I asked why the transport system is that worse and why they keep silent. You also receive ticket from the bus conductor as a receipt for paying. The government allows students to pay the list amount for public transportation however the taxi conductors do not allow them to take seat.

On the bus you can not claim the window to be closed and the volume of the music to be minimized. People just step on you and you do the same and they don't even apologize for that. Things that could irritate you out side are "very okay" on the buses.

One thing that I was happy about was that whether they know each other before or not or meet on the bus for the first time, people talk warmly and laugh. I also was happy on the way some people read newspapers on the buses. Tanzanians have a very good number of newspaper publications which are both in Kiswahili (the national language) and English as well as radio transmission. Television is recently introduced in to the country. Though there was Television in

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## My 10 month stay in Tanzania...

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Zanzibar since 1974, it did not have wide coverage of transmission and did not focus on entertaining local issues. It was a private Television Station which started covering more local issues with a wide transmission in 1994. The first government owned television station commenced in 2000. Totally there are about 5 television channels and provide service in Kiswahili and have some English services.

The public prefer radio and newspaper for their information. Corruptions, parliament, business, and social, as well as regional, continental and international politics are among the top agendas of the media in Tanzania. Women's participation in social, economic and political issues of the country is considered to be one of the important things that the people and government took in to consideration. Unlike what I know in my own country, there are about eight women ministers and many state ministers who are playing decisive roles in the country. In addition to the deputy UN secretary general, Tanzanian women are on the highest positions at the continental and international levels.

Let me share something about an association that I have been sharing an experience with as part of my journalism career. Tanzania Media Women's Association (TAMWA) can be taken as an exemplary for the role that women could play on the development of the country in different aspects. Building the capacity of women journalists for increasing their enrollment on the profession as well as safeguarding the rights of women and children are among the main objectives for the establishment of the association.

TAMWA provides scholarship for members and organizes and offers short term trainings under different topics for women journalists. Regarding the rights of women and children, the association encourages and organizes members to conduct journalistic survey on health, education and other social and economical aspects. It is very common to read press releases and the transmission of different issues on the vibrant media of Tanzania pertaining to women and all these are sent from TAMWA to the different media institutions. Governmental and non governmental organizations, parliamentarians, as well as individuals are very much concerned on the information released from TAMWA and would like to offer quick response to their appeal. Moreover, the association is one of the beneficiaries of the Fredskopset exchange program. This is the program that offered me the

opportunity to stay in Tanzania for ten months. During my ten months stay there, representing the Ethiopian Media Women Association, I have got the chance to write on the newspaper called "The Africa" on different social issues concerning women and children. This created an opportunity to get an exposure and above all it enabled me to improve my journalistic skills.

The fact that Ethiopia enters in to 2000 with pomp and Beyonce's presence and staging in the country have surprised many of them there and I was happy to inform the society there through the stories I produced and published in the newspaper I used to work. Besides, conducting journalistic survey, report and press release writing, organizing seminars and participating on the activities of the association were some of the engagements I have participated.

I have been more familiar with the local foods and I managed to cook some of the foodstuff. Doris Kasote, the exchange participant from Zambia who shared a building with me made me totally African and more specifically typical Tanzanian. The Kiswahili language teacher Thomas also helped me a lot to identify the cultural values of the society in detail. Thomas, who is a musician by profession, shared his experience regarding music and musicians of the two countries. He was always fascinated by the themes of the Amharic music which he said are predominantly on themes related with missing the country, people and different social values. Tanzanians are different in this regard. They are not eager to live outside their country. They are not familiar of going to Arab countries for seeking job and even the American

DV lottery, which most Ethiopians aspire for are not an issue at all there. As a result their songs are all about love and jealousy and don't have such themes like ours.

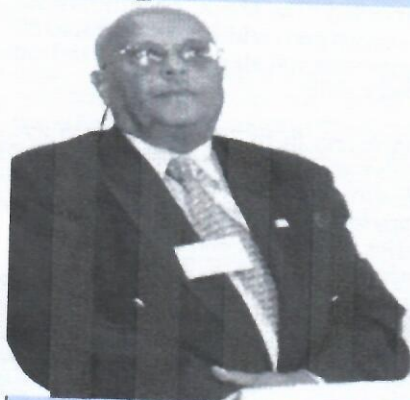
By the way it is very common to see the pictures of the former president Mualimu Julius Nyerere and the current president Jk, Kikwete. They are hanged on the offices, shops, restaurants and market places. I found few Ethiopian families living in Tanzania and some people working there. Most young Ethiopians are detained since they were caught entering the country illegally. The effort I made to talk to the immigration officer about those detainees was not successful.

This is in short my ten month experience in Tanzania as obtained from my diary. TAMWA executive director, Ms, Ananilea Nkya is my model for being strong, committed and job loving person. Above all, I have learnt loving my country from Tanzanians. I still miss Zanzibar, the water, narrow roads, its people and way of life. Last but not least I would like to pass my gratitude for the Fredskopset exchange program. Ba Dayaa Tanzania!

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## Exposure



Mr. Fikre Hailemariam is currently working as a representative for Fredskorpset Africa. Fredskorpset is Norwegian government aid agency which supports Peace Corps program aimed at bringing the development gap between the North to South. The agency has supported a South to south and North to South personnel Exchange Program between organizations in Africa, Asia, South America and Norway since 2002.

Mr. Fikre Hailemariam is an Ethiopian. He had worked in different positions in Governmental organizations including the General Manager of the factory, financial advisor for a construction company, as Deputy General of Commercial Bank of Ethiopia. He also served international NGO'S like save the children Norway as a Director of Finance and Account and Human Resource Development. In addition he has worked as an Assistant Representative of Norwegian save the children in Uganda for 5 years. In 2001 he came across with the FK program.

The FK Africa representative spoke to Mihret Moges, FK 2007 participant from Ethiopian Media Women Association attached to Association of Media Women in Kenya.

Q- How do you explain the impact of your international experience?

Mr. Fikre: - Actually, even in my young age, after I graduated from university and worked in the bank, I was sent to Italy and I was living in Melino for one year studying Economics of Banking. It was the first eye opener living abroad.

## Matters

I also traveled extensively as far as Australia and other European countries.

When I came to Uganda, actually Eastern Africa, and my work as an Assistant representative carry me to villages, districts gave a chance to interact with the communities. It guided me to gain more exposure. Especially in relation to assisting FK work. Because FK work include different Nationalities and countries. My exposure in the Save the Children also has given me input.

Q- Do you think you are transferring your experience to the FK program?

Mr. Fikre: - Yes. It is also what I want. I shared my personal experience. I want FK to be strong with my experience. I want replicate people who can carry the program.

Q- What is the impact of FK Africa South to South program since 2001?

Mr. Fikre: - We started FK as a small strategy in Africa for the first time in 2001. And we developed it time by time. By using some of the experiences from Africa, Asia also started the program. FK Africa is exemplary. It is becoming relevant on increasing the participants level and capacity. For some of them it may be their first experience to go abroad. When they came back they came with a change, with more knowledge and self confident. On organizational level, even though some of the organizations are similar in name, they barely knew each other before FK started. After participated in FK program, they became clause and cooperate country to country and organization to organization. This also brings the society of different countries together. So the program is benefiting the participants, the organizations and the countries that are involved in the FK.

Q- What is FK'S mechanism to follow up Ex- participants?

Mr. Fikre: - The networks that are established in different countries are following up the Ex- participants. FK also has carrier development format, which we ask each participants to fill about their position, where they are, are they promoted or in the same position, have they joined further studies and have they joined club or other societal organization. It keeps them in track.

Q- The FK South to South program since 2001 was evaluated by the external evaluators. What did they recommend?

Mr. Fikre: - External evaluators evaluated the FK program. The evaluation recommended that the program should continue. So we are planning up to 2011. The Norwegian government is satisfied especially on South to South exchange program. They want Fredskorpset to put more money to the same program. Consequently our strategy is to increase the number of partners' for the next 2007 to 2011 years and concentrating in Gender, environment and peace building. In addition, the program will include private companies and governmental organizations.

Q-How South to South program became successful?

Mr. Fikre: - It is because the exchange is relevant. The experience of one organization is relevant to other organization. It is among similar organizations so that they plan together and have planning meetings. The chief executive officers set together and do analysis on their weakness and strength. It is demand driven. Those team works helped for the success.

Q- What is your vision as FK Africa representative?

Mr. Fikre: - Contribution for clear understanding. The FK program is contributing more understanding among people. It is not only experience sharing among participants. It is also bringing culture together. My vision is creating mutual understanding through contribution.

Q- Do you think that you are sharing your personal experience?

Mr. Fikre: - Yes I do. Our activity needs personal interest. Otherwise it is very hard to travel from country to country frequently. We got to a country which we do not know, approach which we do not know, met new society and work in new culture. It needs some effort and commitment. With out commitment, I do not think our job done effectively. I really love to share my experience among African Countries. We have a lot to share each other. However we are not realizing it.

Q- What are the responsibilities of former, current and future participants?

Mr. Fikre: - After they are exposed to the outside world we want the participants to come back home, to assist their organization in any way. Joining in other activities like civic societies and learning to create a better world are also activities that we are expecting from participants.





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EMWA is a non-profit, Non-partisan professional association officially registered with the Ministry of Justice in May 1999 pursuant to the Ethiopian Civil Code 405. The association aimed at promoting women's rights and issues of concern in and through the media. Currently it has over 200 members consisting of women journalists working in private, state owned print and broadcasting media.

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# EMWA

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